

DFT Study Plan – Feedback and Suggestions

Overall Evaluation

Your study plan is well-structured and covers the essential foundations of DFT, DV, and verification. The resources listed in the table are comprehensive, allowing you to progress from Verilog basics to SystemVerilog, UVM, DFT, and interview preparation. However, the current plan emphasizes knowledge coverage. It could be further improved in terms of practice, prioritization, and project depth.

Suggestions for Improvement

1. Time Arrangement

- Early phase: Focus on basics (Verilog, SystemVerilog, UVM skeleton).
- Mid phase: Add small practical exercises (testbench design, simple DFT insertion demos).
- Late phase: Complete 1–2 mini-projects (e.g., scan chain demo, post-silicon debug case study).

2. Practice-Oriented Learning

- Add “project-driven learning”: every new concept should be paired with a small demo experiment.
- Create a **DFT-from-zero GitHub repository** documenting your code and learnings. This will not only reinforce your knowledge but also serve as a strong portfolio for interviews.

3. Depth and Prioritization

- Priority stack: SystemVerilog + UVM → DFT scan/ATPG → Linux scripting and tool usage.
- In the 2 months before interviews, strengthen **debug case studies and common interview questions**.
- Reduce over-broad topics (e.g., deep mathematical background) and stay focused on role-related skills.

4. GPU/AI Supplement

- If interested in GPU C++/modeling, add in the later phase:
 - * Learn basics of gem5/Verilator
 - * Read GPU architecture papers/whitepapers
 - * Join a small open-source modeling project (e.g., NPU/GPU cache simulation)

5. Open-Source and Presentation

- Sync your study notes to GitHub Pages (aligned with your blog) to form a visible **learning trajectory**.
- Try contributing PRs to small open-source projects to gain collaboration experience.
- Include your “DFT learning project + GitHub link” in your resume – this is a strong differentiator.